Mathematics – Shape, Space & Measure – Belonging Curriculum

The Belonging Curriculum provides the foundation for pupils' understanding of shape, space, pattern and measure within their everyday lives. At this stage, pupils are not yet learning discrete mathematical concepts such as geometry, statistics or formal measurement. Instead, they are developing the essential behaviours, awareness and experiences that enable them to interact with, explore and make sense of the world around them.

Through exploration, play, movement, routines and meaningful interactions, pupils learn to notice patterns, explore spaces, manipulate objects, experience shape and size, respond to change and develop awareness of position and relationships within their environment. These early behaviours support participation, communication, independence and engagement in everyday life.

The curriculum is organised into three developmental learning areas which reflect the gradual progression from awareness, to participation, to the recognition of early spatial and measurable relationships. Although pupils may demonstrate learning across multiple areas simultaneously, the framework provides a guide to the typical progression of development within the Belonging Curriculum.

Pathway Aim

By the end of the Belonging Curriculum, pupils will engage with and respond to experiences involving space, shape, pattern and measure in their everyday lives. Through exploration, interaction and routines, pupils will develop awareness of objects, movement, position, pattern, size and change, enabling them to participate in daily activities, make sense of their environment and increase their independence and understanding of the world around them.

Learning Area 1: Awareness, Attention & Anticipation **(Broadly Band 1)**	**Learning Area 2: Participation, Exploration & Response** **(Broadly Band 2)**	**Learning Area 3: Recognition, Matching & Early Relationships** **(Broadly Band 3)**
Pupils develop awareness of shape, space, pattern and measure through attention, curiosity and anticipation of familiar people, objects, actions and routines.	Pupils become active participants in shape, space and measure experiences, exploring, responding and interacting with	Pupils begin to recognise, match and connect objects, spaces, patterns and measurable attributes, developing an

	objects, patterns, spaces and measurable attributes.	understanding of how things relate to one another within their environment.
Key Stage Target By the end of the key stage, the pupil will demonstrate awareness of spatial, shape, pattern and measurement experiences through attention and anticipation.	**Key Stage Target** By the end of the key stage, the pupil will actively explore and respond to experiences involving shape, space, pattern and measure.	**Key Stage Target** By the end of the key stage, the pupil will recognise simple relationships between objects, spaces, patterns and measurable attributes and begin to apply these during play and exploration.
Typical targets might include • I can explore a space when I am free to move, roll and stretch. • I can develop an awareness of my body, that my body has different parts and where these are in relation to each other. • I can explore differently sized and shaped objects. • I can begin to put objects of similar shape inside others and take them out again. • I can show interest in patterned songs and rhymes (e.g. repeated actions). • I can experience patterned objects and images. • I can begin to predict what happens next in predictable situations. • I can respond to very big or very small items.	**Typical targets might include** • I can follow objects or sounds as they are being counted or moved • I can explore space around me and engage with position and direction • I can stack objects using flat surfaces • I can attempt to match shapes with spaces on inset puzzles • I can join in with repeated patterns in songs and stories • I can initiate and continue repeated actions • I can explore different sizes in play • I can empty containers • I can show awareness of routines	**Typical targets might include** • I can engage in filling and emptying a container • I can move objects into and out of spaces • I can explore objects that are near and far away • I can push objects through different shaped holes • I can attempt to fit shapes into spaces on inset boards or puzzles • I can begin to select a shape for a specific space • I can enjoy using blocks to create my own simple structures and arrangements • I can match objects with parts that fit together • I can recognise patterns in my daily routines • I can anticipate what comes next in a story or rhyme • I can begin to arrange items in my own

		patterns • I can sort by colour with some help • I can explore size and weight • I can fill and empty containers • I can begin to understand now/later
Next Step Develop active participation in experiences involving shape, space, pattern and measure.	**Next Step** Begin to recognise relationships between objects, spaces, patterns and measurable attributes.	**Next Step** Develop specific concepts through the Achievement curriculum.